UNIVERSITY OF ST. LA SALLE

Graduate School
Bacolod City

DATA PRIVACY NOTICE AND RECORDS RETENTION SCHEDULE

Data privacy and records retention | Operations Manual 4.23 | Proposed policy - for validation by the Graduate School

Form code	GS-P-04	Revision no.	00	Effectivity date	

INSTRUCTIONS

1. This notice tells every account holder of the Graduate School platform what personal data is kept, why, who sees it, what leaves the platform for an outside service, how long it is kept, and how to use the rights the law gives. A short form of it is shown once at first sign-in; GS-F-45 is its paper twin.
2. Section 5 was written from a reading of the platform's program code on 2026-11-04 (what each call to an outside service sends). It must be re-checked whenever the code changes. Retention periods and the Data Protection Officer's contact are proposed or to be confirmed.
3. At the time of writing the platform is a capstone prototype that holds demonstration data only. This notice is drafted for the day it holds real student records.

1. Purpose, scope and status

1.1 Purpose: to give effect to the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173) for the personal data processed by the Graduate School of the University of St. La Salle in its Graduate Student Lifecycle Monitoring platform.

1.2 Scope: students, faculty members, and staff, coordinators, the Dean and the administrator who hold platform accounts, and the people named in the records the platform keeps.

1.3 Status: proposed. The notice takes effect when the Dean signs below. Official student, enrollment and grade data remain with the University Registrar's system (AIMS); the platform holds a monitoring copy and never overwrites an official value.

2. Legal basis and who is responsible

2.1 RA 10173 and its Implementing Rules and Regulations. The regulator is the National Privacy Commission (NPC), which the Act creates (section 7). The Act's general principles are transparency, legitimate purpose and proportionality (section 11); personal information may be processed on consent and on the other grounds of section 12; the rights of the data subject are in section 16; security is in section 20.

2.2 The University is the personal information controller. The University's Data Protection Officer (DPO) is the contact for this notice. DPO name and contact: to be confirmed.

2.3 Health information (for example a medical certificate attached to a leave request) is sensitive personal information under the Act and is handled with stricter care: it is attached to the request only when the person chooses to upload it, and it is seen only by the roles that decide the request.

3. What the platform keeps, why, and who sees it

Data	Examples	Purpose	Seen by (see GS-P-05)
Identity and program	Name, student number, institutional email, program, year of entry	Know who is enrolled and in which program	Staff, coordinators, Dean; the student sees the own record
Academic progress	Subjects completed, comprehensive examination, research milestones, standing	Monitor progress, advise, check graduation	Staff, coordinators, Dean; the student sees the own record
Case records	Leave, readmission, withdrawal, absence without leave, residency, practicum, graduation endorsement, with reasons and attached files	Run and decide the requests	The roles named for each step; the student sees the own cases
Research records	Title, adviser, panel, defense schedule, verdicts, uploaded papers and evidence	Run the research steps	Research Coordinator, staff, Academic Coordinator, Dean; faculty see only the own panels
Faculty records	Name, college, specialization, email, course preferences, weekly hours, availability, connected calendar	Match panels, propose teaching load, schedule defenses	Staff and coordinators; the faculty member sees the own record
Account and log	Sign-in email, name, role, password hash (never the password), consent time and notice version, transaction log of every recorded step	Sign-in, accountability, proof of approval (GS-P-03)	Staff and the Dean read the log; the administrator maintains the system

4. Sources of the data

4.1 The Registrar's export or the Academic Coordinator's monitoring workbook (identity, enrollment, subjects), the person's own entries and uploads, the staff's records of each step, and, for faculty members who connect it, Google Calendar (section 5).

5. What leaves the platform for an outside service (checked in the code)

5.1 Policy Assistant (Google Gemini, endpoint generativelanguage.googleapis.com). This runs only when a Google API key is set in the server's environment. Without the key the assistant uses keyword search on the server and nothing is sent. The demonstration site is currently started with the key switched off. When the key is on, the calls below are made.

Call	What is sent to Google	What is not sent
Index of the policy library	The text of each library passage, with its title and source (Handbook, Research Protocol, the other built-in documents, and PDFs that staff upload), once to be turned into search vectors, and again when a document changes	Any student, faculty or account data
Each question typed in the assistant	The question text, to be turned into a search vector	The name or role of the person asking
Answer to a policy question	The question and the four or more best-matching policy passages, with an instruction to answer only from them	Any student record
Personal question by a student (for example "What is my next step?")	The question and a short text built from the student's own record: stage, program, standing, progress status, percentage of subjects completed, missing subjects, open tasks, missing documents, the next defense	The student's name and student number (the code leaves them out). Open task titles are sent as written and may contain other names
Personal question by staff, coordinator, Dean or faculty	The question and the list of up to eight items waiting on the person: task titles with the student's name and the due date; for faculty, the panel invitations with the student's name	Passwords, contact numbers, uploaded files
Unclear question	The question text, to decide which kind of question it is	-

Call	What is sent to Google	What is not sent
Panel matching (staff and coordinators)	An excerpt of up to 5,000 characters of the text of the student's uploaded research paper, with the name, specialization and matched terms of the faculty considered; the paper text (first 9,000 characters) and each faculty profile text, for similarity vectors	The student's name, student number and the file name

5.2 Google Calendar (only for a faculty member who connects a calendar from the faculty portal). The platform asks for permission to read free and busy times and to create and change the events it owns. It stores the access and refresh tokens encrypted. When a defense is scheduled it writes an event whose title is the defense type and the student's name, with the time and the venue. The faculty member can disconnect, which asks Google to revoke the access.

5.3 Nothing else was found that sends personal data out of the platform. The platform sends no email: staff send the exports to the Registrar by the University's own email. What each outside service does with the data is governed by its own terms; a data sharing agreement with Google is to be confirmed with the DPO.

6. Your rights

6.1 Under section 16 of the Act the person has the right to be informed, to object, to access, to correct, to have the data suspended, withdrawn, blocked, removed or destroyed, to data portability, and to claim damages. Consent given at first sign-in may be withdrawn in writing; the Graduate School then keeps only what a rule of the University or the law requires.

6.2 To use a right, write to the Graduate School Office or the DPO (contact to be confirmed). The Graduate School answers in writing (proposed: within fifteen working days). A complaint may be filed with the National Privacy Commission.

7. Security measures (checked in the code)

7.1 Passwords are stored as hashes. A generated password must be replaced at first sign-in. Every function behind the sign-in is limited to the roles named for it (GS-P-05). Repeated wrong passwords are slowed. The session cookie is HttpOnly and SameSite Lax, and Secure when the site is served over HTTPS (to be switched on when the platform is hosted). Uploaded files are kept in a folder on the server, not in the web page area. Google tokens are stored encrypted.

7.2 A suspected breach is reported at once to the DPO. The IRR requires the NPC and the affected people to be notified within seventy-two (72) hours of knowledge of a breach that meets the stated conditions (DPO to confirm).

8. Retention schedule (proposed - to be confirmed)

Record	Kept for (proposed - to be confirmed)	Then
Student case files: requests, forms, practicum, research records, log entries of the case	5 years after graduation or after the last enrollment	Delete or anonymize, with the Dean's approval
Graduation endorsement lists (GS-F-43) and Registrar transmittals (GS-F-44)	Permanently	Kept in the Graduate School archive
Uploaded papers and evidence (research, practicum, medical certificates)	As the case file they belong to; medical certificates 1 year after the case closes	Delete
Faculty availability and preferences	While the person teaches in the Graduate School, then 1 year	Delete
Google Calendar tokens	Until the faculty member disconnects or leaves	Delete at once
Account record and consent record	While the account is active, then 5 years (proof of consent and of approvals)	Delete
Policy Assistant questions	Not stored by the platform (checked in the code); Google's own handling is outside the platform	-
Official enrollment and grade data	Not owned by the Graduate School; the Registrar's schedule applies	-

9. Open points for the Graduate School and the DPO

9.1 Name and contact of the DPO; the University's retention rules for student files; whether a data sharing agreement with Google is needed before the Policy Assistant or the calendar link is used with real data; whether the platform may be hosted outside the University; and who may see a medical certificate.

Review and approval

Role and action	Printed name	Signature	Date
Prepared by Capstone group CAP-IT1 (platform project)			
Reviewed by Data Protection Officer of the University (to be confirmed)			
Approved by Graduate School Dean			